



The Grounded Expat

COACHING AGREEMENT

Effective 11 September 2026

1 Who I am, and what this agreement covers

I'm Stephanie Johnson, and I offer one-to-one coaching for adults living abroad through The Grounded Expat. You can contact me at hello@thegroundedexpat.com.

I'm also a licensed independent clinical social worker in Washington State. That background informs my work, but in this relationship I am acting only as a coach. This agreement explains the service, our responsibilities, and the practical terms that apply when you purchase or book coaching.

2 Coaching is not therapy

Coaching is not psychotherapy, counseling, mental health treatment, medical care, diagnosis, or healthcare of any kind. It is also not legal, financial, immigration, or other professional advice.

I won't diagnose or treat a condition, provide a treatment plan, keep clinical records, submit insurance claims, or provide documentation for reimbursement. No therapist-client or healthcare-provider relationship is created. Coaching starts from the assumption that you're capable of making your own decisions, and we work on what you're trying to understand, decide, or change.

3 Who coaching is for

You must be at least 18 years old and able to enter into this agreement. Because coaching may not be regulated or treated the same way everywhere, you are responsible for deciding whether it is appropriate and lawful for you to receive coaching where you are physically located.

Tell me if your location changes in a way that could affect our work. If you are a current therapy client of mine or of the practice where I provide therapy, I can't also provide coaching to you. A coaching client can't later become my therapy client.

4 If something needs more than coaching

Sometimes something surfaces that would be better served by therapy, medical care, legal advice, or another kind of support. If I believe that is happening, I'll tell you directly. I may recommend pausing or ending coaching and finding an appropriately licensed local professional. I can help you think through what kind of support to look for, but I can't guarantee that a particular referral or resource will be available or suitable.

5 This is not a crisis service

I'm not available for emergencies, and I don't continuously monitor email or messages. If you're in crisis, thinking about hurting yourself or someone else, or need urgent help, contact the emergency number where you are, go to the nearest emergency department, or contact a local crisis service. In the United States, call or text 988. Elsewhere, findahelpline.com provides a country-by-country directory.

Please know the emergency resources where you are physically located. We may be in different countries, and I may not know the correct service for your location.

6 Privacy, confidentiality, and its limits

I treat what you share as private and won't sell it or use it in my writing, newsletter, social media, or marketing without your separate, explicit permission. Coaching is not therapy and may not carry the same legal privilege or confidentiality protections as healthcare. I can't promise absolute confidentiality.

I may disclose information when you authorize it; when disclosure is required by a valid law, court order, or other legal process; when a reporting duty applies to me, including a duty concerning suspected abuse or neglect of a child or vulnerable adult; or when I reasonably believe disclosure is necessary to respond to a serious and imminent threat of harm. The exact duty may depend on the law that applies to the people and locations involved.

I keep coaching notes to a minimum and store them with reasonable safeguards. Session recaps and any notes are coaching records, not clinical records, medical records, or treatment plans. Scheduling, payment, email, video, transcription, and note-assistance services may be provided by third parties, including Cal.com, Stripe, Google, the selected video provider, and any note-assistance provider identified to you before use. Those providers process information under their own terms and privacy practices, and data may be processed in countries other than your own. Please don't put sensitive clinical information in scheduling forms or ordinary email. See thegroundedexpat.com/privacy/ for more information.

7 Sessions and scheduling

Sessions are 60 minutes by video and are booked through the private scheduling link I provide after purchase. That link is for you and shouldn't be shared. A Bearing includes one booking use. The Crossing includes six booking uses.

Booking confirmations show the time in the time zone selected on the scheduling page. Please check it carefully, especially when you travel or daylight saving time changes. Availability may change, and purchasing a session or package doesn't guarantee a particular date or time.

8 Cancellation and rescheduling

Please give at least 24 hours' notice if you need to move or cancel a session. A cancellation with less than 24 hours' notice, or a session you don't attend, counts as used unless I decide otherwise because of exceptional circumstances. If I need to cancel, we'll reschedule at no additional cost. If we can't find a reasonable replacement time, I'll refund the affected session at the rate you paid for it.

9 Fees, packages, expiry, and refunds

Payment is made in advance through Stripe. **A Bearing** is one session for **\$175 USD**. **The Crossing** is six sessions for **\$895 USD**, paid in full in advance. Unless we agree otherwise in writing, The Crossing sessions are intended to be used within six months of purchase.

A completed session and a late cancellation or no-show that counts as used are non-refundable. If you end The Crossing before using all six sessions, unused sessions will be refunded at the package's per-session rate, calculated as the package price divided by six, subject to any rights that can't legally be limited. If six months passes with unused sessions, we'll either agree in writing to a reasonable extension or I'll refund the unused sessions at that same package rate. Stripe processing times and currency conversion may affect when and how a refund appears.

10 Session recaps, recording, and note assistance

After each completed coaching session, I'll provide a brief written recap intended to help you remember the main topics, insights, decisions, resources, and action steps we discussed. I'll review the recap before sending it to you, but it may not capture every detail and you should tell me if something important appears inaccurate. A recap is a practical coaching resource, not a verbatim record, clinical note, medical record, diagnosis, or treatment plan.

You may choose an **AI-assisted recap** or a **manually prepared recap**. If you affirmatively consent to AI assistance, the session may be transcribed and, only when technically necessary, recorded so an automated note-assistance service can prepare a draft. I will identify the service before it is used. If you don't consent, I will prepare the recap manually. Your choice won't affect your access to coaching or its price.

Consent to AI-assisted note taking is separate from acceptance of this coaching agreement. You may change your choice or withdraw consent before or during a session. We will also confirm your choice at the beginning of the session. If consent is withdrawn during a session, recording or transcription will stop as soon as reasonably possible, and I will prepare the recap manually.

When AI assistance is used, the recording and full transcript will be deleted within 14 days after the recap is delivered, unless a longer period is required by law or reasonably necessary to address a security incident or legal dispute. The final recap may be retained as part of the limited coaching record described in the Privacy Policy. Neither of us may otherwise record, transcribe, photograph, or use an automated meeting assistant without the other's clear agreement in advance.

Technology and automated summaries can fail or make mistakes, and no online system can be guaranteed completely secure. If a session is materially interrupted, we'll try another method or reschedule the remaining time.

11 Between sessions

If something practical comes up, email me at hello@thegroundedexpat.com. I'll usually reply within two business days. Coaching happens during scheduled sessions, not over email, and I don't provide ongoing or emergency support between sessions.

12 Your choices and responsibility

You decide what to discuss, what actions to take, and whether coaching remains useful. You are responsible for your decisions, wellbeing, safety, and use of outside professional support. I don't promise or guarantee a particular outcome. You agree to provide information that is accurate enough for us to work safely and honestly.

13 Ending the coaching relationship

Either of us may end the coaching relationship at any time. I may end or pause coaching if I believe it is outside the appropriate scope, creates a conflict, can't be provided safely, or isn't serving you. Any eligible unused prepaid sessions will be refunded under Section 9. Terms that logically continue after the relationship ends, including privacy, payment, responsibility, and governing-law terms, remain in effect.

14 Governing law and limits

This agreement is governed by the laws of the State of Washington, United States, without regard to conflict-of-laws rules. Any dispute will be handled in the state or federal courts located in Washington, unless a mandatory law where you live requires otherwise. If part of this agreement is unenforceable, the rest remains in effect.

To the fullest extent the law allows, neither The Grounded Expat nor Stephanie Johnson is responsible for indirect, incidental, special, or consequential loss arising from coaching, and total liability will not exceed the amount you paid for coaching during the six months before the event giving rise to the claim. Nothing here excludes liability or consumer rights that the law doesn't allow us to exclude.

15 Electronic agreement

By checking the required Coaching Agreement box in the booking form and completing a booking, you confirm that you've had access to a copy you can save, that you've read and understood it, that you agree to conduct this transaction electronically, and that you accept these terms. Payment confirms your purchase but doesn't replace the required agreement checkbox. Any separate AI note-assistance choice is optional and isn't acceptance of this agreement. If a material term changes, the updated agreement will apply only after you receive it and accept it for future coaching.

Please keep a copy.

Questions about this agreement can be sent to hello@thegroundedexpat.com before you purchase or book.